

JOSE ACOSTA

Data Engineer | High-Availability Real-Time Systems | ex-Quant Trader (4Y)

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PROFILE:

Data Engineer who learned the cost of bad data trading real capital for 4y. I build systems where quality, latency, and reliability aren't technical details—they're business risks. My background (quant trading + civil PM) taught me that data engineering is about enabling decisions under pressure, not just moving data. I ship pipelines built for reliability: comprehensive testing, observability frameworks, and automated failure recovery. I close the gap between engineering rigor and business value, deliver when decisions can't wait, and speak both languages. Remote

SKILLS:

Languages: Python, SQL

Real-Time & Streaming: WebSocket/REST ingestion, streaming pipelines, TimescaleDB

Data Platforms: Snowflake, Databricks, AWS (S3, Lambda), PostgreSQL

Orchestration & Transformation: Apache Airflow, dbt, PySpark, ETL/ELT patterns

Reliability Engineering: pytest, dbt tests, monitoring/observability, data lineage, alerting frameworks, CI/CD (GitHub Actions)

DevOps & Infrastructure: Docker, Kubernetes, Terraform, IAM, secrets management

Development: FastAPI, Streamlit, data modeling, data quality frameworks

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS:

- IBM Data Engineering Professional Certificate (in progress) — Coursera
- Data Science with Python — University of Michigan, 2024
- Inferential Statistical Analysis with Python — University of Michigan, 2024
- Professional Python Development — EasyCode, 2023
- Associate's Degree, Civil Engineering Technology — IUTAJ (Venezuela), 2013

LANGUAGES

- Spanish — Native | English — Professional Working Proficiency

EXPERIENCE:

Data Engineering Consultant for Trading System — Remote

Aug 2024 - Jun 2025

TraderDaddy | Part-time

- Reduced research iteration time that was blocking quant teams from testing strategies. Built Python/SQL backtesting frameworks with automated validation and CI/CD (GitHub Actions), reducing cycle time 40% and increasing throughput 5x.
- Solved delayed analytics caused by stale market data. Engineered real-time WebSocket → Snowflake pipeline with idempotent loads and schema validation, eliminating manual fixes and enabling same-day feature engineering for trading models.
- Reduced operational incidents through automated Airflow workflows on AWS S3 with predictable recovery (retries, alerting), data quality gates, and SLA-aware scheduling—cutting incident response time and operational toil.

Data Engineering Consultant (Contract) — Self-Employed

Sep 2022 - Jul 2024

- Automated repetitive manual work that was causing late deliveries and weekend firefighting. Orchestrated self-recovering batch/streaming pipelines in Airflow with SLA monitoring, automated retries/alerting, and one-click backfills—adding data quality gates and full lineage tracking.
- Solved analytics teams building duplicate datasets and waiting days for clean data. Shipped end-to-end data platform on AWS (S3/Lambda) + Snowflake with production-grade dbt models and tests, cutting time-to-insight from weeks to hours.
- Enabled fraud detection team to run suspicious transaction scoring APIs (FastAPI) and Dockerized microservices on Kubernetes, delivering sub-100ms response times with production-grade uptime SLAs

Head of Trading & Quantitative Data Systems — Caracas, VE

Feb 2019 - Jul 2022

Fintech Alca Group, SA

- Reduced backtesting time from weeks to hours, blocking quant researchers from testing new strategies. Rebuilt portfolio optimization pipelines in Python/SQL with parallelization and caching, delivering 5x throughput and reproducible datasets for compliance audits.
- Accelerated trading decisions from days to hours, directly supporting \$100k+ capital allocation choices. Shipped real-time dashboards backed by reliable PostgreSQL/TimescaleDB datasets with SLA-monitored refresh schedules eliminating stale data risk.
- Built the firm's entire data foundation from scratch when traders were still using Excel and manual downloads. Engineered production ETL/ELT ingesting real-time + historical market data (REST/WebSocket) into governed warehouse with quality gates, schema versioning, and 24/7 monitoring—powering every quant model and live strategy.